KEYNOTE PRESENTATIONS

Miller Puckette

Abstract

When we listen to a well-played music, we hear it as if the player were making the music, and the instrument were a transparent conduit through which the music flows. When listening to a bad performer, our attention often is attracted to the instrument itself. When making music with a computer, it can be hard to avoid calling attention to what the computer is doing; and yet it would seem desirable, at least by analogy, to have the computer be as transparent a part of the music-making process as an instrument can be. In this talk I'll try to identify some patterns of computer usage that either call attention or avoid calling attention to the medium (the computer); many useful and entertaining examples are available from teh standard computer music repertory. I'll try to make some useful generalizations as to what a musician might wish to try to do or avoid doing to evade some of the many artistic traps the computer can so easily lure us into.

Biography

Miller Puckette obtained a B.S. in Mathematics from MIT (1980) and Ph. D. in Mathematics from Harvard (1986). He was a member of MIT's Media Lab from its inception until 1987, and then a researcher at IRCAM (l'Institut de Recherche et de Coordination Musique/Acoustique), founded by composer and conductor Pierre Boulez. There he wrote the Max program for MacIntosh computers, which was first distributed commercially by Opcode Systems in 1990 and is now available from Cycling74.com. In 1989 Puckette joined IRCAM's musical workstation team and wrote an extended version of Max, called Max/FTS, for the Ircam Signal Processing Workstation.

Puckette joined the Music department of the University of California, San Diego in 1994, where he is now chairman. From 2000 to 2011 he was Associate Director of Center for Research in Computing and the Arts (CRCA) at UCSD.

He is currently working on Pure Data ("Pd"), a leading open-source real-time multimedia arts programming environment, with software contributions by many others worldwide. Puckette has collaborated with many artists and musicians, including Philipe Manoury (whose Sonus ex Machina cycle was the first major work to use Max), and Rand Steiger, and Vibeke Sorensen (as part of the Global Visual Music project). Since 2004 he has performed with the Convolution Brothers.

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Michael Young

Abstract

Computational systems able to collaborate with human improvisers are *live algorithms:* able to cooperate proactively, on an equal basis, with musicians in performance. This is an ideal that raises fundamental questions about creativity and group interaction, how these might be computationally modelled. Can musicians and computers relate to one another, just as human musicians do? Can an audience recognize and appraise this relationship? Live algorithms offer the prospect of a new understanding of real-time creative practice that differs from the established paradigms in live electronic music: *computer as instrument* and *computer as proxy.* Drawing upon ideas from social psychology and pragmatics, collective music-making can be viewed as a special case of social cooperation, evidenced primarily through sound. To attempt a functional description of live algorithms is to model modes of cooperation and causal attribution that occur between proactive agents in a shared *sonic* environment. The challenge of live algorithms is to find genuinely original ways for humans and computers to work together - an original way to make music. The ideal live algorithm paradigm is *computer as partner.*

Biography

Dr.Young is a composer with interests in real-time computer music, interdiscipinary practice and performance. He was born in South Shields in 1968. He studied music at Oxford University and composition with John Casken & Peter Manning at Durham University, completing a PhD in 1995. He is a Senior Lecturer in Music at Goldsmiths, University of London in the Electronic Music Studios (EMS). Previously, he lectured at Oxford Brookes University and University of Wales, Bangor. His recent music has focussed on interactive/generative systems, exploring the interface between composed and improvised music-making. He is co-founder of the Live Algorithms for Music Network. He has worked with jazz musicians and improvisers as pianist, laptop musician & composer.
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